

committee to review the implementation process. "The Government is also issuing guidelines on how to go ahead with the order, but this is likely to make it a complex and time consuming process," he adds. Official sources point out that the entire repatriation and the exercise of making fresh appointments will cost the state Rs 80 crore.

Chief Minister Reddy is trying to uphold the spirit of the Six Point Formula (SPF) that was thrashed out in the mid-1970s when the Government of India restored peace between those demanding the division of the state into two—Telangana and Andhra. It is in the third point of the SPF, where protec-

and safeguard public employment rights for the locals. The amendment authorised the President of India to make special provisions with respect to the state. The irony is that Reddy is being forced to implement the G.O., as the government employees from the Rayalaseema region are unhappy with the implementation of SPF.

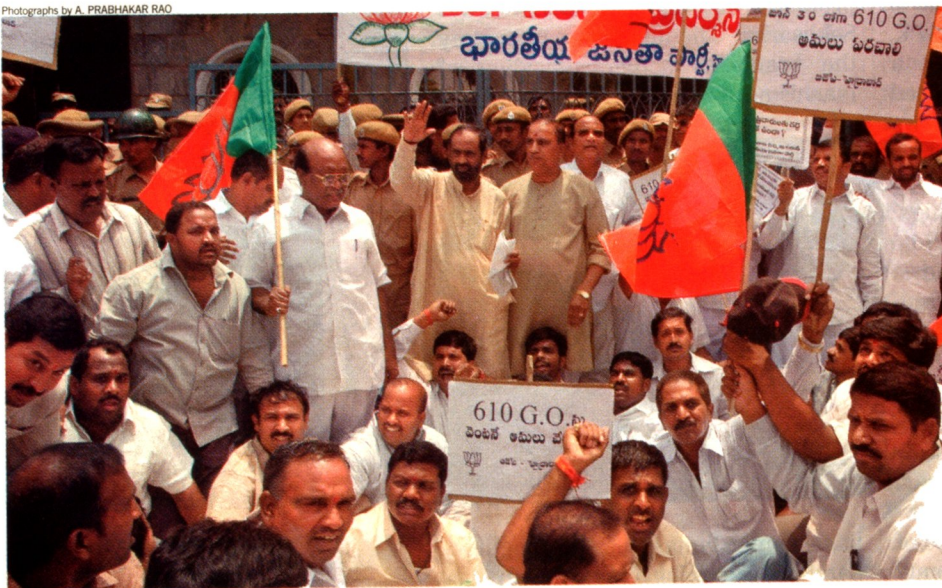
The state Government is facing an onslaught of the separatist Telangana Rashtra Samithi (TRS) and other opposition parties on the issue. Even, a few in the ruling Congress have added a new dimension **PRE-EMPTIVE: The political fallout of the delay worries the Government**

series of day-long demonstrations outside offices of government departments, demanding the repatriation to be completed quickly. "The resignation of the seven Congress legislators shows their scant respect for the Constitution," says BJP state president, Bandaru Dattatreya.

Others argue that a forceful homecoming of employees would create chaos and anarchy in the state. "Forceful repatriation is even worse than division of the state. Will all those who are pressing for it drop their demands for a separate Telangana state after implementing the G.O.?" asks former MLA T.G. Venkatesh. He feels that the order is only a ploy to trigger the disintegration of Andhra Pradesh.

For nearly 22 years G.O. 610 has remained a vexatious paper issue. Successive chief ministers, including three of the Congress party, did not show the gumption and the will to carry out the order that would have paved a way for more government job opportunities for aspirants from Telangana. The Girglani Commission submitted its final report on the deviations in the implementation of the presidential order, with suggestions to safeguards right on December 30, 2004. The state Government did not table this

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10,000 employees in 103 departments will be affected by the order

tion of government jobs for the locals is mentioned. When this was formulated in 1984, N.T. Rama Rao appointed a four-member committee, followed by a one-man commission, V. Sundaresan, a retired IAS officer, to examine and recommend ameliorative and corrective steps in implementation of the SPF. But due to its controversial nature, G.O. 610 was issued only on December 30, 1985 by the NTR government, to repatriate by March 31, 1986 all the non-locals who were appointed by the presidential order of October 18, 1975 to the Telangana region. This was followed by an amendment in the Article 371 (D) of the Constitution to rectify anomalies

to it. As many as seven Congress legislators of the state have resigned in protest against the manner in which the members from Telangana district in the committee are monitoring the G.O. "We are not opposed to implementing the order, but are finding the functioning of the committee objectionable," says a senior Congress MLA Gade Venkat Reddy. "There has been some misunderstanding, which would be soon cleared out. They will be persuaded to withdraw their resignations," says the house committee chairman and Congress legislator N. Uttam Kumar Reddy. The BJP, which is now supporting the demand for a separate Telangana, has begun a

report during the state assembly session in December 2004 and waited till February 16, 2005 to present it during the budget session. It was only after several complaints and protests that Reddy agreed to the constitution of a house committee to monitor the process of implementation in December 2006.

However, Reddy is concerned about the political fallout if there is any further delay. He feels that it will fuel the pro-Telangana sentiment and exacerbate regional tensions if effective steps are not taken for time-bound repatriation. He may not be able to overcome the bureaucratic and other hurdles that crop up. ■